enough so that they are not affected by the operation of other devices in the house such as ovens or cordless phones, etc.

The primary aim of these sensors is to collect raw data from the patient's body such as heart rate, temperature, pressure, glucose levels, etc. The data collected by these sensors is wirelessly transmitted to an external processing unit located inside the house or on the patient's body. US has a special frequency band called Wireless Medical Telemetry System (WMTS) which is meant for transmission of data related to a patient's health. IEEE in fact has established a task group called IEEE 802.15.6 for standardization of WBAN. Since it is a wireless transfer of data, security measures will need to be put in place to ensure mass adoption of such technologies.

After relevant processing, this data can be transmitted to a remote server of a hospital which is monitored by resident doctors or it can be sent directly to your personal physician's handheld device. This transmission can make use of your regular data networks such as ethernet or Wi-Fi or cellular spectrum. As the data is being sent in real-time, you have an assurance that if anything untoward is picked up by the sensors, the response time of the doctors should be quick. This will help medical professionals to detect issues with health beforehand. Also, it does help in saving multiple trips to the doctor or hospital for getting checkups and reports.

Although WBAN as a system is still not heard of in India, the immediate advantages of implementing it soon are tremendous. In rural areas for instance, where it might not be possible for patients to visit doctors or hospitals as often as it is in cities, or if hospitals are located far off from their residence. It also helps in reducing healthcare costs to a great extent.

Flexible Displays

Cellphone are getting sleeker by the day and the display technology is undergoing changes slowly but surely. From TFT displays we have moved onto AMOLED displays, making them contrast-heavy, making images and videos more vivid, increasing resolutions, among other things. So, next is what?
The clue lies in the end of the last para.

Mobile phone manufacturing giant, Samsung showcased a flexible AMOLED display back in 2011, whose screen was made of a plastic called polyamide which renders the screen unbreakable. This year again at CES we saw Samsung showcasing a flexible display cellphone prototype, whereas LG had flexible e-ink reader measuring a measly 0.3mm in thickness, production of which has already started according to some reports. Nokia also showcased its proof-of-concept Kinetic cellphone which although not a touchscreen, but has a flexible display which can be programmed to navigate through music and photos by bending the screen in certain ways.

Apart from the novelty of being able to bend displays, the possibility of lower power consumption display is what is more tempting. Not to forget, if these flexible displays are able to be rolled up or folded, then it can save some amount space in your pockets. Think a rollable display with a broadsheet newspaper form factor. Use the immense screen real estate and when you're done, just fold it up and keep it in your bag.

While cellphones and e-readers seem like the initial consumer products that may come out of this technology, the possibilities are endless for advertisers and marketers as well. Tablets with flexible displays can be opened up to enjoy movies on a bigger screens and then be folded back for regular surfing. Wear a future Apple iOS device as a wristband. We will not elaborate much about the materials as we are planning to do a bigger story just on Flexible Displays next month, so do not forget to check it out.

Flexible displays

WHAT'S NOT

On the other hand there are some technologies which we are disowning at a quick rate. Go back five years and you will realise that you have stopped using at the very least, one of the following technologies:

Entry level graphics cards

Processors these days come equipped with enough integrated graphics prowess to tackle tasks such as HD playback, basic gaming, multiple displays, etc. Intel had entry level integrated graphics with the Sandy Bridge processor lineup. AMD replied with a superior integrated graphics component with the Llano series of processors. Intel has recently come out with Ivy Bridge processors which sport much better integrated graphics than the Sandy Bridge chips. In fact so good is the IGP on Llano and Ivy Bridge, that you can even play games at a decent 30 fps and over frame-rate at a resolution of 1366x768. Where do you think that leaves entry-level discrete graphics cards?

While hardcore gamers will definitely go for dedicated graphics cards - as they have enough raw horsepower than that found on the integrated graphics on the processor-the future seems really bleak for entry level GPUs. First of all, these entry level GPUs are pathetic at gaming at higher resolutions and secondly, the advantages such as flawless HD playback are easily gained on the IGP. In fact, Intel's Quick Sync video feature puts most of the entry level GPUs out of the water, when it comes to tasks such as transcoding videos.